lack of other partners (thwarting India's desire to diversify); and sufficient political will and capacity to undertake a tilt.

In both cases, it was China that represented that threat and drove India toward alignment. Even in the US-India case, that alignment was not just momentary. It might not have constituted a full-blown alliance, but before and after 1962, it facilitated close cooperation in the military, intelligence, and economic spheres. This was a period when each country showed a greater tolerance toward the other's approach toward partnerships. But there were also missed opportunities that are worth heeding today.

This book details those missed opportunities, and aims to offer a broader set of insights for present and future policymakers about the US-India-China triangle—an even more fateful one with regional and global implications. It provides historical context for many of the challenges and opportunities related to the bilateral and trilateral relationships facing Indian and US policymakers today. And it offers lessons—of possibilities, limitations, and caution—from past experience that can inform current and future policies.

A few notes on what this book is not: it is not a study of China as an actor in the US-India relationship, but of when and how China was a factor shaping the relationship; whether, why, and how Chinese policymakers actively sought to shape US-India relations merits further study, but it is beyond the scope of this book. Also, while it includes information on public opinion where available, it is a book about high (geo)politics, not a view from below. Finally, the book does not seek to be the final word on the subject—as more information becomes available, there will no doubt be additional aspects and interpretations that come to light.

This book builds on existing scholarship of the relationships between these three countries. It also uses primary sources. In the US, these include official papers available through the presidential libraries, the National Archives, and document collections such as the Foreign Relations of the United States series. In India, sources include the official documents and private papers of senior policymakers accessible at the Nehru Memorial Museum and Library, the more limited Ministry of External Affairs papers available at the National Archives of India, and documents in the *Selected Works of Jawaharlal Nehru* series. There remain gaps in the availability of